

PREST POS - Order Workflow & Security Guide

EXECUTIVE

A Step-by-Step Plain-English Guide for Operations & Management

DATE: September 16, 2026

AUDIENCE: Store Owners & Management

PLATFORM: PREST POS System

1. Core Concept in Simple Terms

While an order is actively being prepared in the kitchen, staff can modify items, add instructions, or cancel it if a customer changes their mind. However, once payment is collected and the order reaches its final step (e.g. Delivered), the system permanently locks the order as Read-Only. This protects the business against internal cashier theft, prevents altered bills, and guarantees 100% tax (GST) compliance.

2. Step-by-Step Operational Workflow

Step	Stage Name	Who Handles It?	What Happens in the System?
Step 1	Store Setup	Store Admin	Admin sets custom stages (Accepted -> Cooking -> Packing -> Delivered) and marks the last stage as the Final Step.
Step 2	Order Punching	Cashier / Waiter	Staff punches items and assigns table or takeaway. Kitchen Order Ticket (KOT) prints automatically. Order is active & editable.
Step 3	Kitchen Prep	Kitchen Staff	Chefs & packers see the order on Workstation/KDS and advance steps (Cooking -> Ready). Staff cannot touch prices or delete bills.
Step 4	Payment & Lock	Cashier / Customer	Customer pays (Cash, UPI QR, or Card). Financial amounts lock instantly. When marked 'Delivered', order is permanently locked.
Step 5	Returns & Refunds	Store Manager	If a customer returns food, the original bill is NEVER deleted. Manager issues a 'Refund / Credit Note' with a recorded reason.

3. Why Completed Orders Must Be Locked

- Zero Cash Theft: Prevents cashiers from collecting cash from customers, deleting the bill later, and pocketing the cash.
- 100% Tax & GST Safety: Under tax laws, invoice numbers must be continuous (INV-001, INV-002, INV-003). Deleting bills creates broken sequence gaps that trigger automated tax penalties.
- Bank Reconciliation: UPI and Card payments deposit directly into the business bank account linked to GSTIN. Locking bills ensures POS sales match bank statements to the exact rupee.
- Accurate Food Cost: Kitchen ingredients deducted for prepared dishes match recorded revenue without unexplained inventory losses.

4. How Customer Returns & Refunds Work Legally

Action	What the System Does	Why It Protects the Business
Original Sale (e.g. Rs. 5,000)	Recorded as Gross Revenue with full tax breakdown.	Proof that a legal sale occurred; invoice sequence is preserved.
Customer Returns Dish (e.g. Rs. 500)	Manager clicks 'Issue Refund' and enters return reason.	Creates an auditable Debit record (-Rs. 500) with manager authorization.
Final Accounting Balance	Net Taxable Sales = Rs. 4,500 (Rs. 5,000 sale minus Rs. 500 refund).	100% legal, transparent, and accepted by government tax auditors.

Executive Summary for Boss / Owner Approval:

1. Active orders can be freely edited by staff during kitchen food preparation.
2. The moment payment is received and the final step is reached, the order is permanently locked.
3. Any customer returns are handled via the 'Refund' button, keeping bills 100% audit-proof and fraud-free.